

with chaos. Even in ancient Rome, taverns drew everyone—proving humans have always been drawn to a good meal and lively company

Zeus himself in the role of Xenios, patron god of guests.

SEAMLESSLY

CHAOS MASTERY

4,000 YEARS OF HOSPITALITY

HOSPITALITY: A JOURNEY THROUGH TIME

BABYLON TO BOSTON — HOW THE WORLD BUILT THE SPACE

~1974 BCE
BABYLON

BABYLONIAN TAVERN LAW

The Code of Hammurabi imposed severe penalties — including death — for tavern keepers who diluted beer or overcharged customers. Hospitality was state-regulated commerce. These were the earliest recorded hospitality standards in human history.

Source: *Star Tavern*, startavern.net

800-1974 BCE
ANCIENT GREECE

XENIA, LESCHES & PHATNAI

Greek culture institutionalized hospitality as sacred law. The *lesche* — a place for council and conversation — and the *phatnai* served travelers, traders, and diplomats. Refusing a stranger shelter was a religious offense against Xenios, protector of guests and strangers.

Source: *HRC International*, hrc-international.com; *Star Tavern*, startavern.net

200 BCE–400 CE
ANCIENT ROME

ROMAN MANSIONES & TABERNAE

Rome established *mansiones* — state-run inns for officials along road networks. Private *tabernae* served the common traveler. Though considered socially disreputable, Roman taverns attracted every class of society, including senators who attended in disguise.

Source: *HRC International*, hrc-international.com; *Star Tavern*, startavern.net